into the SCO could be interpreted as Beijing pursuing a binding strategy.

Conclusion

The most dramatic changes in China's policy towards India occurred in the 1950s and 60s, with China moving the PLA to the Indian border in Tibet, followed by the 1962 border war, and then China's support to Pakistan. These were all measures taken by Chinese authorities to consolidate what it perceived as China's legitimate border. Protecting stability on its Western frontier led Beijing to hem in India's influence by engaging with countries in India's neighbourhood, with Pakistan as the pillar of this policy. India's growing ties to the Soviet Union in the 1960s and 70s elevated the importance of India in Chinese strategic and geopolitical calculations, although Beijing's new channel to the United States contributed to a more stable positioning shaped by the two strategic triangles, the US–China–Soviet triangle and the Soviet–India–China triangle.

With the end of the Cold War, China's foreign policy priorities and its geo-strategy changed. Even if Beijing and New Delhi normalised relations, and bilateral, regional, and multilateral platforms for dialogue between China and India were established, India gradually lost its earlier prominence in Chinese strategic thinking. Moreover, as China's economy expanded through the 1990s and into the 2000s, opening a huge power gap vis-à-vis India, and Beijing's interests increasingly targeted the maritime Western Pacific and the United States, India and South Asia were to a certain degree neglected. Nevertheless, recent developments have reversed this outlook.

Beijing is now rolling out a very ambitious policy towards Eurasia and the Indian Ocean Region, leading China to